ARTEFAKT.FOUNDATION

Witness. Connect. Preserve. Sustain.

Local Roots - Global Impact

Nothing of value should be discarded.

Not materials.

Not memories.

Not communities.

Not the truth.

Artefakt is building a new model for sustainable storytelling that will support building the next generation of ethical and impactful documentarians.

Origins

From global documentary practice to a Calgary pilot in sustainable storytelling

After thirty years of documentary and arts based work across the world—with deep connections to local communities in Chicago—Jon Lowenstein moved to Calgary to build a family life and begin again.

After the pandemic, he began a pilot from his garage: recovering, repairing, and reselling discarded electronics and objects. What emerged was more than income. It became a way to meet newcomers, neighbors, and people from every walk of life—and a way to fund storytelling from the ground up.

Artefakt grows from that discovery: community, recovery, and trust can help sustain documentary work.

Truth, Democracy, and the Image

As documentary institutions shrink and AI and social media accelerate synthetic media, public trust in images is weakening.

- Documentary practice creates a shared record of reality
- Supports accountability
- Preserves voices that would otherwise disappear
- Creates new pathways for supporting democracy

Artefakt frames truth-telling as a democratic value and a public cultural responsibility.

What We Do

WITNESS

Documentary photography, film, and storytelling as direct and ethical act

CONNECT

Build understanding across communities, sectors, and borders

PRESERVE

Protect our shared histories through preserving objects, and visual records that matter

SUSTAIN

Use ecycling and material recovery to educate community members andfund cultural work

Local Roots - Global Impact

Chicago

Long-term trust, South Side relationships, and a body of work built over decades. Physical space to work out of.

Calgary

A new operational base and the first official home for Artefakt at 4525 Monterey Ave NW, Suite 240.

Global Impact

A practice shaped across borders: migration, conflict, labor, family, and cultural memory.

Project Pilot: Proof of Concept

This new space is the first official public year, but the model has already been tested over multiple years

$90K+

sold in sustainable goods through informal garage pilot

~1,000

objects kept in circulation and out of the waste stream

Built through scavenging, repair, thrifting, resale, and direct exchange.

Artefakt aims to make ecycling a new model for sustainable storytelling.

With a dedicated space, the pilot can become public, repeatable, and institutionally legible.

Year 1 earned-income target: $40,000 CAD

The Artefakt Model

Sustainable storytelling through systematic ecycling, documentary practice, and public engagement

Recovery

Scavenging, thrifting, collection, and intake

Repair + Sort

Testing, cleaning, triage, and preparation

Resale

Sustainable goods re-enter circulation

Earned Revenue

Mission-aligned income from reuse

Documentary Work

Photography, film, exhibitions, and commissions

Archive + Education

Preservation, workshops, and knowledge transfer

Public Impact

Community connection, access, and truth-based storytelling

Proof of concept already exists.

Garage pilot to date: over $90K in sustainable goods sold and nearly 1,000 objects kept in circulation. The new Calgary space makes this model systematic, public, and programmatic.

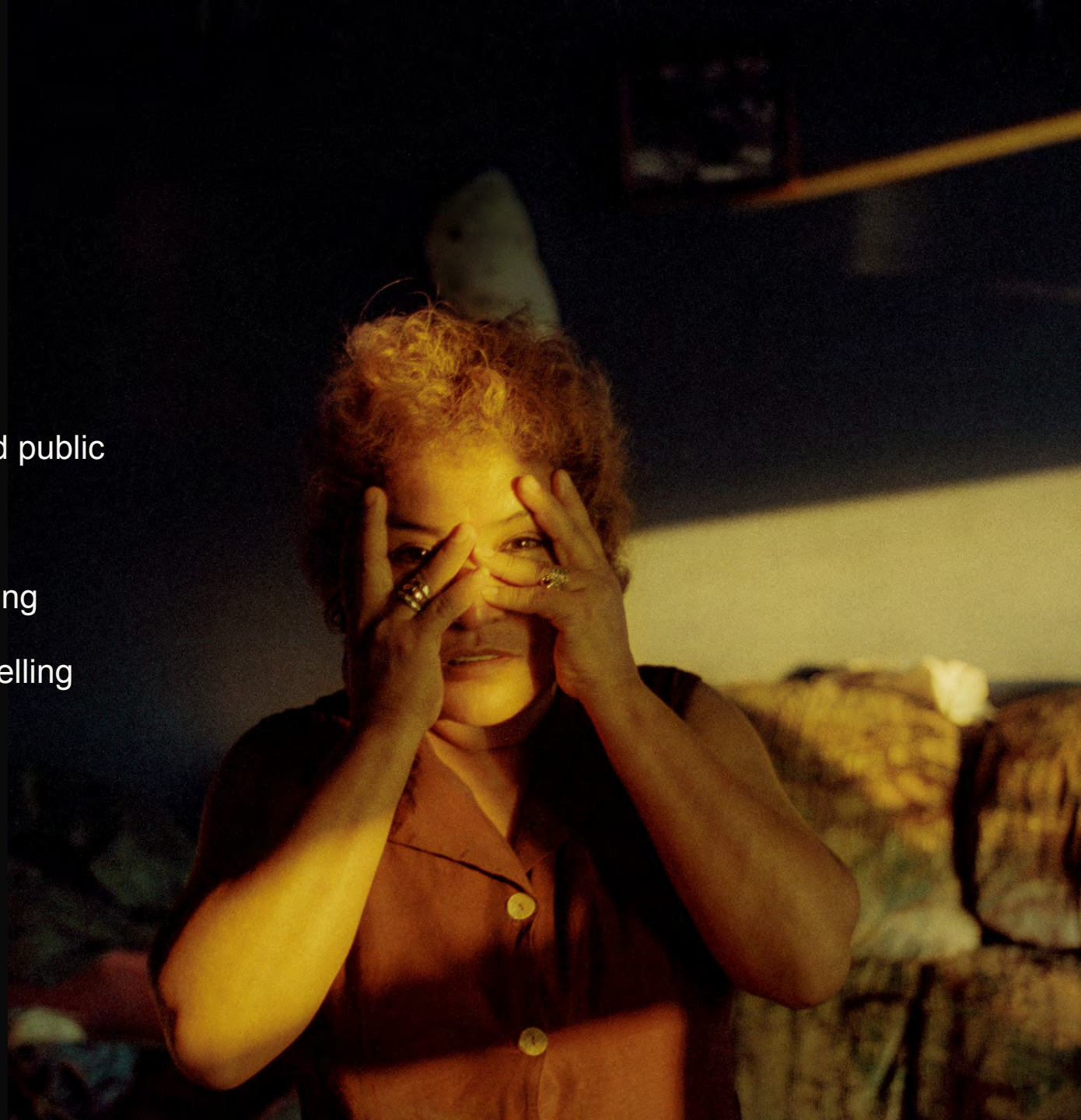
Target Year 1 mix: 51% earned income / 49% contributed support

Year One in Calgary

LEASED - 4525 Monterey Ave NW, Suite 240

- Launch ecycling and resale program in a dedicated public space
- • 4 exhibitions with local and global artists
- 4 workshops
- Begin archive, documentation, and community-facing programming
- Establish a repeatable model for sustainable storytelling

Focused, public-facing, and realistic for a first official year.



Year 1 Budget (CAD)

Simple first-year operating budget for launch in Calgary

Facility / occupancy (rent, utilities, insurance, rehab)	$17,000
Exhibitions (4)	$10,000
Workshops / education (4)	$15,000
Ecycling operations / transport / storage/expenses	$5000
Archive / documentation / storage	$5,000
Communications / website / outreach	$5,000
Part-time coordination / admin	$18,000
Contingency	$5000
TOTAL	**$80,000**

Budget logic

Modest first-year programming paired with real operational costs for a permanent public base.

More than alf of the budget is designed to be earned through mission-aligned e-cycling and arts activity.

Revenue Model and Funding Request

Expected earned revenue	
Ecycling / resale	$35,000
Workshop fees	$3,000
Small sales / editions	$2,000
TOTAL EARNED	**$40,000**

$35,000

funding request for grants, donors, and founding support

Grounded in the pilot
$90K+ already sold two years
through informal recovery and resale.

Artefakt aims to make systematic ecycling a new model for sustainable storytelling.

Seeking founding support for Year 1 launch in Calgary.

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